

FLAGS HONOR – COMPLETE NOTES

1. What is a Flag?

A flag is a piece of cloth with colors, symbols, or designs used to represent a country, organization, group, or belief.

Uses of Flags (Any 3)

1. National identity – Represents a country
2. Communication – Signals messages (ships, camps)
3. Ceremony & honor – Parades, worship, funerals

2. Study of Flags

The study of flags is called VEXILLOLOGY.

3. Basic Types of Flags (With Explanation & Example)

a. Badge

A flag with a symbol placed on a plain background

✓ Example: Many state flags

b. Bicolor

A flag with two colors only

✓ Example: Poland (white & red)

c. Burgee

A swallow-tailed or pointed flag

✓ Example: Yacht club flags

d. Canton

A flag with a small design in the top corner

✓ Example: USA flag

e. Coupled Cross

A cross with double bars

✓ Example: Patriarchal cross flags

f. Cross

A flag with a single cross design

✓ Example: Christian flag

g. Pennant

A long triangular flag

✓ Example: Naval signals

h. Quartered

A flag divided into four equal sections

✓ Example: Historical royal flags

i. Serration

A flag with zigzag or toothed lines

✓ Example: Qatar

j. Triangle

A triangular-shaped flag

✓ Example: Nepal (unique)

k. Triband

A flag with three stripes

✓ Example: France

l. Guidon

A small flag used by military units

4. Meaning of Common Flag Colors

(Meanings may vary by country)

Red – Blood, sacrifice, bravery

Blue – Peace, loyalty, sky

Black – People, strength, hardship

Green – Agriculture, land, hope

White – Peace, purity

Yellow – Wealth, sunshine, minerals

5. Parts of a Flag (Defined Simply)

Canton – Top corner near the pole

Field – Background of the flag

Fly – The part that waves freely

Fly End – Outer edge of the flag

Hoist Side – Side attached to the pole

Halyard – Rope used to raise/lower flag

Flagstaff – Pole holding the flag

Truck – Ball or ornament on top

Finial – Decorative top piece

6. Care and Handling of the National Flag

1. Never let it touch the ground

2. Do not use it as clothing or decoration

3. Store it clean and folded properly

7. Folding the National Flag

Fold neatly

Keep symbols visible

Store in a clean, dry place

8. Saluting the Flag (Etiquette)

In Uniform (Standing or Marching)

✓ Give proper salute

In Field Uniform

✓ Same respect applies

With Headgear

✓ Salute unless instructed otherwise

Not in Uniform

✓ Stand at attention, hand over heart

9. Pathfinder Flag

Designed by: Helen Hobbs

First sewn by: Helen Hobbs

Colors Meaning

Blue – Loyalty

White – Purity

Red – Christ's sacrifice

Gold – Excellence

Emblem Meaning

Shield = Faith

Sword = Bible

Flames = Holy Spirit

Cross = Christ

10. Christian Flag

White field – Purity

Blue canton – Faith

Red cross – Jesus' sacrifice

11. Hoisting & Lowering Flags

Hoist briskly

Lower slowly and respectfully

National flag goes highest

12. Half-Staff (Half-Mast)

A flag is flown at half-staff:

To show mourning

On national tragedies

During death of leaders

👉 Raise to top first, then lower halfway

13. Lighting the Flag at Night

A national flag must be properly illuminated if flown at night.

14. Displaying the National Flag

Parade

National flag leads

Never dips

Platform

Right side of speaker

Wall (Vertical/Horizontal)

Canton always upper left

Casket

Covers casket

Never touches ground

Multiple Nations

Same height

Alphabetical order

Equal size

15. Disposal of a Worn Flag

Must be done respectfully

Usually by burning ceremony

Never thrown away

16. Carrying the Flag (Color Guard)

Hold upright

Walk with discipline

Show respect at all times

17. History of Your National Flag

(You explain:)

When it was adopted

Meaning of colors & symbols

18. Division Flags

Know:

Your Division flag

Countries it represents